

1979 GENERAL ELECTION CAMPAIGN PLEDGES

LIBERAL DEMOCRATIC PARTY (LDP) 01:79
OHIRA, PRESIDENT

1. Tax Increase

In order to promote the development of government and rehabilitate the large financial deficit, we will carry out thorough reductions in expenditures and rationalize financial liabilities by rationalizing the so-called 3 K's (kome/rice, kokutetsu/national railway, and kenko hoken/health insurance), making drastic readjustments in subsidies, carrying out administrative reform, and reducing personnel expenses. At the same time, these policies will ensure that tax revenues will increase naturally because of the revival of the economy.

In the case, however, where revenues cannot be ensured to pay for increased social security costs because of our aging society, we will explain the situation to the people, investigate ways to ensure that the burden that does not put pressure on family finances, and obtain the understanding needed to deal with the situation.

2. Inflation and Energy

The prices and the supply and demand of petroleum products have stabilized and we have the necessary supply. Therefore, we

believe that there is no need to worry about further inflation of oil prices. From now on, we will stabilize the price of oil by eliminating and guarding against pernicious price gouging, the hoarding of goods, and the cornering of markets. To deal with the recent continuation of increases in wholesale prices, we will strengthen constraints on increased supplies and speculative demand.

In order to ensure long term stability of energy supplies, we plan to do the following: 1) promote substitutes for petroleum as a source of energy by promoting the development and use of nuclear energy, expanding the use of coal and natural gas, and promoting the development of new types of energy such as solar power; 2) disperse the sources of imported oil, develop independent explorations, and expand the storage of oil; and 3) make every effort to conserve energy.

3. Correction of Political Corruption

In order to establish political ethics, we will strive to make reforms that will enforce party discipline, as well as strive to change the current election system based on candidates that requires lots of money to one based on parties that does not.

In order to ensure discipline of public officials, we plan to do the following: 1) press for sure rewards and punishments, 2) strengthen the supervision of administration, 3) carry out impartial official procurements, 4) regulate the licensing and

authorization of items, 5) extend the statute of limitations and strengthen penalties toward bribery, and 6) eliminate excessive intervention in the lives of people. Also, in order to purify politics, we will investigate plans to clean up political funds of individual politicians, set up a Diet ethics committee in order to extend the investigative ability in relation to government, and ensure corporate ethics.

4. Welfare and Expenses

In order to realize high social welfare in the period of aging, we plan to fulfill improvements of the social security system based on just burdens and fair benefits.

The pension system is undergoing a financial recalculation for fiscal year 1980, and we plan to improve survivors' benefits and stabilize pension finances. We plan to stabilize finances by realizing the giving of equal benefits to the beneficiary of the health insurance and his family, make just the individual burdens, and cancel the high burden on family finances.

5. Foreign and Defense Policy

We will actively promote peace diplomacy by furthering friendship with all countries, strengthening cooperation with the various Asian and Pacific countries and the various democratic countries, contributing to the development of the world economy, expanding technical economic cooperation and working to settle the North-South issue, and working towards the return of the Northern Territories and the conclusion of a peace treaty between

Japan and the Soviet Union.

We will ensure the peace and security of Japan by maintaining the Japan-U.S. security system and expanding our self-defense capability in accordance with our national resources.

6. Education

We place our goals of education policy on developing youth with vitality who are rich in solidarity and public spirit and possess ample creativity and individuality. We want to establish school education with less rigidity that is consonant with moral, intellectual, and physical education. We plan to establish a university of the air, expand the facilities of regional universities, and eliminate the differentials among regions and diversify secondary education. We plan to advance the rationalization and improvement of the common first round and second round entrance examinations to national and public universities.

JAPAN SOCIALIST PARTY (JSP) J2:79
ASUKATA, CHAIRMAN

1. Tax Increase

We are opposed to increased income taxes and the introduction of a general consumption tax. A general consumption tax of 5 percent will bring in revenues of 3 trillion yen and will increase the burden per person by 100 thousand yen, thereby hurting family finances. Financial reconstruction is possible by correcting the unfair tax system and increasing taxes of large cor-